OSCOLA 5 in Zotero — metadata entry guide

Companion to `oscola-5th-edition.csl`. Every rule below is what the style expects; if a field is left empty, that element simply disappears from the citation.

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1. EU legislation → Zotero item type **Statute**

OSCOLA element	Zotero field	Example
Full title incl. type + number	**Name of Act**	`Council Directive 2002/60/EC of 27 June 2002 laying down specific provisions for the control of African swine fever`
`[year]`	**Date Enacted**	`2002`
OJ series	**Code**	`OJ`
Series letter + issue	**Code Number**	`L192`

OSCOLA element	Zotero field	Example
First page	**Pages**	`27`
Short form for later footnotes	**Short Title**	`Rome I Regulation`

Output: `Council Directive 2002/60/EC of 27 June 2002 laying down specific provisions for the control of African swine fever [2002] OJ L192/27.`

Same pattern for EU treaties and protocols — only the series letter changes:

> `Consolidated Version of the Treaty on European Union [2020] OJ C202/1 ('Maastricht Treaty').`

Pinpoints: in the Word/LibreOffice citation dialog set the locator type to *Article* or *Section* and type `3(1)` → `…, art 3(1)`.

UK / domestic statutes: leave **Code**, **Code Number** and **Pages** empty. The year lives inside the Name of Act, so nothing else is printed: `Human Rights Act 1998, s 15(1)(b).`

Assimilated EU law (OSCOLA 5, 2.4.9): type `Assimilated` at the front of the Name of Act, leave Code empty, and put the amending SI in the Name of Act as OSCOLA shows.

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2. International treaties → **Statute + one line in *Extra***

In the **Extra** field, the very first line must be:

```
Type: treaty
```

This switches the item to the CSL `treaty` type and changes the whole output shape.

OSCOLA element	**Zotero field**	**Example**
Treaty title (+ parties, if bilateral)	**Name of Act**	`Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees`
adopted …	**Date Enacted**	`28 July 1951`
entered into force …	**Extra:** `Original-date: 1954-04-22`	
Series volume	**Code Number**	`189`
Series	**Code**	`UNTS`
First page	**Pages**	`137`

OSCOLA element	Zotero field	Example
Short form	**Short Title**	`Refugee Convention`

Extra field looks like this:

```
Type: treaty
Original-date: 1954-04-22
```

Output: `Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees (adopted 28 July 1951, entered into force 22 April 1954) 189 UNTS 137 ('Refugee Convention').`

For bilateral treaties, type the parties into the Name of Act exactly where OSCOLA prints them, e.g. `Agreement on Trade (Israel–Jordan)`.

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3. Cases → Zotero item type Case

One template covers CJEU, ECtHR, ICJ, ICC and arbitral tribunals. What matters is *which fields you leave empty*.

Zotero field	What goes in it	Printed
Docket Number	`Case C-403/03` (type the word "Case")	before the case name

Zotero field	What goes in it	Printed
Case Name	party names only — this is what gets italicised	italic
Extra: `Genre: (Merits) (Judgment)`	phase / type of decision	roman, after the name
Court	`ECtHR`, `ACHPR` …	after the name
Reporter Volume / Reporter / First Page	report or identifier information	in that order
Date Decided	only where OSCOLA prints a date in brackets	`(15 June 2009)`

The five patterns

CJEU / General Court — ECLI replaces the old ECR reference:

- Docket Number `Case C-403/03`, Case Name `Schempp v Finanzamt`, Reporter `EU:C:2005:446`, **Date Decided empty**
- → `Case C-403/03 Schempp v Finanzamt EU:C:2005:446 [19].`

ICJ — the year is part of the report reference, so put it in Reporter Volume:

- Reporter Volume `[2021]`, Reporter `ICJ Rep`, First Page `71`, **Date Decided empty**
- → `Application of the … (Qatar v UAE) (Preliminary Objections) (Judgment) [2021] ICJ Rep 71.`

ECtHR:

- Court `ECtHR`, Reporter `App Nos 8019/16, 43800/14 and 28525/20`, Date Decided `25 January 2023`
- → `Ukraine and the Netherlands v Russia (Jurisdiction and Admissibility) (Decision) [GC] ECtHR App Nos … (25 January 2023) [826].`

ICC / criminal tribunals:

- Reporter `ICC-01/05-01/08`, Date Decided `15 June 2009`
- → `Prosecutor v Bemba (Decision on the Confirmation of Charges) ICC-01/05-01/08 (15 June 2009).`

Arbitral tribunals:

- Reporter `ICSID Case No ARB/01/8`, Date Decided `12 May 2005`
- → `CMS Gas Transmission Company v Argentina Republic (Merits) (Award) ICSID Case No ARB/01/8 (12 May 2005).`

Pinpoints: set the locator type to *Paragraph* → `[19]`. Judgment paragraphs are the only pinpoints that take square brackets.

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4. Academic and secondary sources

Source	Zotero type	Notes
Book	Book	Publisher must be entered as OSCOLA abbreviates it (`OUP` , `CUP` , `Hart Publishing`), **not** "Oxford University Press". Delete the Place field — OSCOLA never prints it.
Chapter	Book Section	Editors go in the Editor field; the style writes `in … (eds), Title` .
Journal article	Journal Article	Put the OSCOLA abbreviation in **Journal Abbr** (`ILJ` , `EL Rev` , `CML Rev`). Volume empty → the style switches to `[2012] Crim LR 100` .
Book review	Journal Article	Add `Genre: book review` in **Extra** → prints `(book review)` at the end.
Thesis	Thesis	5th edn italicises thesis titles. Type = `MPhil thesis` , University =

Source	Zotero type	Notes
		`University of Oxford`.
Command paper	Report	Report Number `CP 815` → `(CP 815, 2023)`. Leave it empty for ordinary reports and the publisher + year print instead.
Newspaper	Newspaper Article	Do **not** fill Place — 5th edn dropped the city of publication.
Website / blog	Web Page / Blog Post	See below.
Lecture or speech	Presentation	Type = `Speech at the Carbon Expo Conference`, Place = `Cologne`.
Generative AI output	Document	Author `ChatGPT`, Title `response to 'Explain X'`, Publisher `OpenAI`, Date.

Websites — the one rule that changed most

OSCOLA 5 prefers a persistent link (Perma.cc) or a DOI, and **drops the access date** when you use one.

- **DOI present** → printed as `DOI: 10.17176/…`, no angle brackets, no access date. Put it in the DOI field (or `DOI: …` in Extra for types without the field).
- **Perma.cc link** → put it in URL and **clear the Accessed field**. The style only prints `accessed …` when Accessed is filled.
- **Ordinary URL** → leave Accessed filled; you get `<url> accessed 16 July 2023`.

Zotero fills Accessed automatically, so clearing it is a deliberate step each time.

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5. Things the style handles automatically

- **No more `ibid`.** Later footnotes render as `Craig (n 12) 360.` using the real footnote number. Legislation and treaties use the short form alone: `Rome I Regulation.`
- Four or more authors → first author + `and others`.
- Bibliography inverts names and initialises forenames (`Zweigert K and Kötz H`), repeats the same author as `—`, and drops the closing full stop.

6. Things it cannot do

- **Tables of Cases and Legislation.** CSL produces one flat bibliography. Generate it, then cut the legal items into separate tables manually, or keep cases and legislation in a separate Zotero collection and export that collection on its own.

- **Short-form case names.** Fill **Short Title** with `Schempp` so later footnotes read `Schempp (n 6) [22]` rather than repeating the full name.
- **Automatic OJ / law report abbreviations.** Whatever you type is what prints, so keep abbreviations consistent from the start.